

# Lesson 18 Practice: Software Categories

JKSSB Computer Awareness

October 10, 2026

**Provenance:** All 25 questions are original exam-pattern questions (*[Original]* plus the *[JKSSB FAA-pattern]*, *[JKPSI-pattern]*, *[SSC CGL-pattern]*, and *[JKSSB-pattern]* extension items, including MSQs); none reproduces an official paper item.

**Q1.** *[Original]* Software is best defined as:

- A. the physical parts of a computer that can be touched.
- B. a set of programs or instructions that tell the computer what to do.
- C. only the operating system supplied with the machine.
- D. the data kept in secondary storage.

**Q2.** *[Original]* Which of the following is **system software**?

- A. MS Word
- B. Operating System
- C. A payroll package
- D. A media player

**Q3.** *[Original]* Expand OS.

- A. Open Source
- B. Operating System
- C. Output Storage
- D. Office Suite

**Q4.** *[Original]* Which of the following is **application software**?

- A. A device driver
- B. The operating system
- C. MS Excel
- D. The BIOS

**Q5.** *[Original]* Which one of the following is **utility software**?

- A. An antivirus program
- B. A web browser
- C. MS PowerPoint

D. A compiler

**Q6.** *[Original]* In the context of programming, expand IDE.

- A. Integrated Development Environment
- B. Internal Data Engine
- C. Integrated Disk Editor
- D. Internet Data Exchange

**Q7.** *[Original]* Compilers, interpreters, and assemblers together belong to:

- A. application software
- B. programming software (language translators)
- C. utility software
- D. embedded software

**Q8.** *[Original]* Software that is permanently stored inside a washing machine or a microwave oven in order to control it is called:

- A. application software
- B. embedded software
- C. freeware
- D. middleware

**Q9.** *[Original]* Middleware is best described as:

- A. software that connects different applications and systems, sitting between the operating system and application software.
- B. the physical wiring that connects two computers.
- C. a free trial version of a software product.
- D. the hardware located inside the CPU.

**Q10.** *[Original]* Which of the following is **NOT** system software?

- A. Operating system
- B. Device driver
- C. MS Word
- D. BIOS

**Q11.** *[Original]* Which statement correctly distinguishes open-source software, freeware, and shareware?

- A. All three make the source code freely available.
- B. Open-source makes the source code available; freeware is free of cost but its source may be closed; shareware is a trial version that later requires payment.
- C. Freeware always provides the source code, and shareware is free forever.
- D. Open-source software and shareware mean the same thing.

**Q12.** *[Original]* Open-source software means software:

- A. that is free of cost only.
- B. whose source code is available to view, modify, and redistribute under its licence.
- C. that can be used only for a short trial period.
- D. that carries no copyright of any kind.

**Q13.** *[Original]* Freeware is software that:

- A. is distributed free of cost, although its source code may not be available.
- B. always includes its full source code.
- C. must be paid for after a fixed trial period.
- D. has no owner and no licence.

**Q14.** *[Original]* Shareware is software that:

- A. is fully free and provides its source code.
- B. is offered as a limited trial and requires payment for continued or full use.
- C. forms part of the operating system.
- D. is exactly the same as public-domain software.

**Q15.** *[Original]* Public-domain software:

- A. is protected by strict copyright.
- B. has no copyright and may be used freely.
- C. is a limited trial version.
- D. always requires a licence key before use.

**Q16.** *[Original]* Evaluate the statements:

- I. An operating system is system software.
- II. Freeware and open-source software mean exactly the same thing.
- III. Shareware is usually distributed as a trial version.

- A. I and II only
- B. I and III only
- C. II and III only
- D. I, II, and III

**Q17.** *[Original]* Expand GPL.

- A. General Public License
- B. GNU General Public License
- C. General Purpose Language
- D. Global Program Loader

- Q18.** *[Original]* The main purpose of utility software is to:
- A. help users create documents and presentations.
  - B. perform maintenance tasks such as antivirus scanning, disk cleanup, and backup.
  - C. translate source code into machine code.
  - D. connect two different applications to each other.
- Q19.** *[Original]* Application software is commonly divided into:
- A. general-purpose and specific-purpose (custom) software.
  - B. system software and utility software.
  - C. freeware and shareware.
  - D. primary and secondary software.
- Q20.** *[Original]* Which of the following pairs is correctly matched?
- A. Proprietary software — source code freely available to everyone
  - B. Open-source software — source code available under a licence
  - C. Freeware — software that must always be paid for
  - D. Shareware — software that never requires payment
- Q21.** *[JKSSB FAA-pattern]* Which of the following is system software?
- A. Operating system
  - B. Railway timetable book
  - C. Cricket bat
  - D. Paper file
- Q22.** *[JKPSI-pattern]* MS Excel is best classified as:
- A. application software.
  - B. system boot firmware.
  - C. a hardware device.
  - D. a network cable.
- Q23.** *[SSC CGL-pattern]* Which of the following is an example of application software?
- A. Word processor
  - B. BIOS chip
  - C. Motherboard
  - D. Power supply
- Q24.** *[JKSSB-pattern]* (MSQ: select ALL correct options.) Which of the following are application software?
- A. Word processor
  - B. Spreadsheet package

- C. Presentation package
- D. Operating system kernel

**Q25.** *[SSC CGL-pattern]* (MSQ: select ALL correct options.) Which statements about software categories are correct?

- A. System software manages hardware resources.
- B. Application software serves end-user tasks.
- C. Utility programs assist maintenance and management.
- D. An operating system is application software.

**Q26.** *[PYQ-adapted: JKSSB Sub-Inspector 2022, QCRIAS item 329; SRC-17/SRC-22]* Which software is designed to control computer hardware and provide services for applications?

- A. System software
- B. Application software
- C. User data
- D. Presentation theme

**Q27.** *[Original]* Which is a utility program?

- A. Disk cleanup tool
- B. Word processor
- C. Presentation file
- D. Device cable

**Q28.** *[Original]* Freeware is primarily classified by its:

- A. Price to the user
- B. Source-code license alone
- C. Processor architecture
- D. Storage medium

**Q29.** *[Original]* Open-source software is distinguished primarily by access to its:

- A. Source code under a license that permits specified use/modification
- B. Hardware schematics in every case
- C. Free support hotline
- D. User's private data

**Q30.** *[Original, MSQ drill]* (MSQ: select ALL correct options.) Which are software categories or licensing/distribution labels?

- A. System software
- B. Application software
- C. Utility software
- D. Open source